

Grammar

Verbs

The Simple Present

The Present Continuous

Exercise 1

1. Juhani Aalto <**works**> for the Finnish Coast Guard.
2. He <**lives**> with his family in a small town on the coast of Finland.
3. His children <**go**> to school in the town.
4. His wife <**drives**> the children to school every morning.
5. Juhani only <**has**> a short commute to the Coast Guard station.
6. Every day he <**listens**> to the radio and <**answers**> messages.
7. Sometimes he <**thinks**> that life is dull.
8. He <**reads**> many books and <**chats**> with his fellow workers.
9. The summer <**is**> a very busy time.
10. Many holidaymakers <**come**> with their yachts and motorboats in the Finnish archipelago.
11. They do not always <**navigate**> their boats very well and do not <**know**> the Finnish waters.
12. They <**give**> the Coast Guard a lot of work.
13. The weather in the archipelago <**changes**> very suddenly.
14. The wind <**increases**> into a gale very quickly.
15. Autumn <**comes**> early in Finland, the water is cold and there are heavy storms.
16. And then the Finnish Coast Guard vessels <**help**> many seafarers.

Exercise 2

1. Captain James **sails** on his yacht every holiday.
2. Today the sun **is shining**.
3. Listen! The dog **is barking**.
4. Hush! The baby **is sleeping**.
5. John can't come to the phone. He **is taking** a shower.
6. We always **travel** by air.
7. Tim never **comes** late.
8. Look at Timothy! He **is riding** his bicycle with no hands.

9. Andrew **is shaving** at the moment.
10. He **shaves** every other day.
11. The vessel usually **takes** only bulk cargo but on this voyage we **are carrying** containers as well.
12. This morning I **am having** coffee, although I generally **take** tea.
13. I see that Tom **is smoking** a pipe today. Yes, he **prefers** cigars but **does not buy** them often because they are rather expensive.
14. At home Captain James **plays** chess every Tuesday. This week he **is playing** on Wednesday, instead.
15. Maria **lives** with her aunt in London where she **is studying** English at present.
16. Be quiet. Can't you see I **am speaking** on the radio?
17. I never **expect** many Christmas presents, although I always **receive** some presents. This year the company I work for **is giving** us a cheque.
18. Sam seldom **drinks** wine with his meals. He **takes** water generally.
19. John often **interrupts** when another person **is speaking**.
20. He often **lies** down in the afternoon. He **is resting** now. Sometimes he **falls** asleep.

The Past Tense

List of irregular verbs

The Past Continuous

Exercise 1

Ocean and sky

A sailor's world in the good old days was (be) rough. They were (be) completely at the mercy of the weather, which sometimes left (leave) them stranded for days without wind. When the wind blew (blow) into a storm they feared (fear) shipwreck. There are many tales about the hardships they endured (endure). Sailors depended (depend) on the sea for their livelihood, but it often cost (cost) them their lives.

Living space

The crew on a sailing vessel lived (live) in the forecabin, an area below the decks and close to the bow of the ship. They chose (choose) their bunks wherever they found (find) a place

among the cargo, usually on hay or fur. They **<did not have/didn't have>** (not have) a place to bathe or do laundry so the forecastle **<smelt>** (smell) very unpleasant.

Work

When they were not sailing the seamen **<helped>** (help) to maintain the ship. They **<repaired>** (repair) the rigging and **<oiled>** (oil) the mast. They **<risked>** (risk) their lives when they **<climbed>** (climb) up and down the masts and the rigging even in heavy weather. They **<worked>** (work) very hard. Every ship, no matter how well built, still **<took>** (take) on water, so they **<pumped>** (pump) the ship every day. At least once a year they **<re-caulked>** (re-caulk), **<tarred>** (tar) and **<painted>** (paint) their vessel. While working the sailors often **<sang>** (sing) sea shanties to keep a rhythm together and keep their spirits up.

Clothes

Sailors **<were>** (be) often great tailors. They **<made>** (make) their own clothes from scraps of sail canvas. They **<wore>** (wear) scratchy loose shirts and baggy trousers that **<hung>** (hang) to their knees. Many sailors **<could not/couldn't>** (can+negation) afford shoes and none **<had>** (have) socks. All sailors **<had>** (have) belts, though, where they **<kept>** (keep) a knife and a marlin spike.

Food

Most often the crew **<fed>** (feed) on hard tack, hard bread, often full of worms, or they **<ate>** (eat) dry salted meat. They **<drank>** (drink) rum, tea, or water which often **<went>** (go) stale and **<became>** (become) contaminated.

Punishment

Some Captains **<were>** (be) very cruel and **<condemned>** (condemn) their men to harsh punishments. The sailors especially **<hated>** (hate) the "cat of the nine tails", used for flogging. There are many horror stories of cruel Captains that tarred and **<feathered>** (feather) sailors or **<keel-hauled>** (keel-haul) them, i.e. **<tied>** (tie) them to a rope, **<swung>** (swing) them overboard and **<dragged>** (drag) them round underneath of the ship.

Compared to all this, life at sea today is perhaps not so bad after all, even if it sometimes is a bit of a drag!

Exercise 2

A Day in the Country

Last weekend we **sailed** to my brother's country cottage by Lake Saimaa. It **was** a very hot day, the sun **was shining** and there **were** no clouds in the sky. We **went** swimming and **stayed** in the water for hours. Afterwards we **had** a barbecue on the beach. While my brother **was grilling** the steaks and chops we **made** a salad and **set** the table. My brother then **brought** some cold wine from the fridge. We **ate** and **drank** to our heart's content. I **ate** so much I **fell** asleep in the sun. I **dreamed** I **was working** on the Ms Marina again.

In my dream we **met with** a heavy storm as we **were crossing** the North Sea. While the ship **was rolling** in the waves the cargo **started** to shift. We **worked** like slaves to save both ship and cargo. I **began** to feel quite panicky, when I suddenly **woke up**. I **sat** up and looked around me. I **realised** it had been only a bad dream. I **was** surrounded by family and friends on a beautiful summer afternoon. The birds, **were singing** the bees **were humming** and the branches of the trees **were waving** gently in the summer breeze. My sister-in-law **was coming** down the garden path. She **was carrying** a tray with coffee cups and a large strawberry cake. In the evening we **heated** up the sauna. We **competed** to see who could stand the heat the longest. I **won**, naturally. I then **jumped** into the moonlit lake for a midnight swim. "This is paradise - there is nothing like a Finnish summer", I **thought**.

Exercise 3

1. He **was sitting** in a tea-room when I **saw** him.
2. When I **went** out, the sun **was shining**.
3. The boy **fell down** while he **was running**.
4. When the war **began** I **was living** in London.
5. The light **went out** when I **was having** tea.
6. My friend **was singing** when I **entered** the room.
7. I **was eating** my dinner when he **came** to see me.
8. When the phone **rang** I **was having** a bath.

Exercise 4

Port Said Harbour

We (enter) <were entering> Port Said harbour when I (come) <came> up on deck. As soon as our ship (come) <came> near enough, a large number of boats (set out) <set out> from the shore. We could see that they (bring) <were bringing> money-changers and men selling all the wonderful things of the East. While I (leave) <was leaving> the ship I (notice) <noticed> that the rest of the passengers (argue) <were arguing> about the prices in loud voices. I (walk) <walked> about for an hour and (watch) <watched> the lively street life: men (sell) <were selling> strange fruits and vegetables, and tradesmen (mend) <were mending> shoes or (make) <making> carpets in their little shops. I (return) <returned> to my ship as the sun (set) <was setting>; the "market" on the ship still (continue) <continued/was still continuing>.

An old man, who (sit) <was sitting> on the deck (offer) <offered> me a beautiful Persian rug for only 10 pounds. I (talk) <talked> hard for ten minutes, and just as the ship (sail) <was sailing>, I (buy) <bought> it for 1 pound. As I (go) <went> to my cabin, I (see) <saw> a sailor with a rug like mine. I (ask) <asked> him the price. "Five shillings", he said, "but it (cost) <cost> too much. A man I (talk) <was talking> to just now only (pay) <paid> two shillings". As I (undress) <was undressing> that night, I (notice) <noticed> a little piece of cloth which (hang) <was hanging/hung> from a corner of my rug. On it (be) <were> the words "Made in Manchester".

The Present Perfect Tense

Exercise 1

The engineer <has examined> the fuel pumps.

He <has not/hasn't taken> out the fuel valves.

He <has inspected> the valves for cracks.

He <has washed> the filters and dried them.

He <has repaired> the leaking pipes.

The engineers <have fitted> new piston rings.

The engineers <haven't/have not checked> the boilers for leaks.

They <have tested> the valve seats.

They <**have overhauled**> the fire-fighting equipment.

They <**have cleaned**> the cylinders.

The Passive Voice

Exercise 1

1. Today radar **is** much used both in ships and ashore.
2. Vessels **are** equipped with radio transmitters.
3. The ship's position must **be** checked often on charts.
4. This can **be** done in different ways.
5. The radar scanner **is** usually installed very high.
6. The picture on the screen must not **be** disturbed by masts, derricks etc.
7. The derricks **are** used to load the cargo.

Exercise 2

1. A distress message **was** sent at 16 00 hours.
2. Where **was** it picked up?
3. Those machines **were** manufactured in Finland.
4. Radio beacons **were** built along the coast.
5. Which range scale **was** used?
6. The goods **were** transported by ship.
7. They **were** delivered on time.

Exercise 3

1. Pilotage **has been** suspended.
2. Navigation **has been** closed in this area.
3. Many changes **have been** made in the fairway.
4. All the necessary arrangements **have been** made.
5. The ship **has been** secured to the quay.
6. Extra tarpaulins **have been** stretched over hatches
7. All loose gear **has been** fastened.

Exercise 4

1. Paper **is** produced in Finland today.
2. That car **was** made in Japan last year.
3. What languages **are** spoken in your country today?
4. When **was** that house built? Last year.
5. These houses will **be** repaired this year.
6. Something must **be** done about it immediately.
7. Pilotage has **been** suspended for small vessels.
8. These books **were** printed last year.
9. Can this shirt **be** washed in a washing-machine?
10. Has the gun **been** loaded?

Exercise 5

The two survivors of the Berge Istra disaster were <**picked up**> by a Japanese fishing vessel.

Leon used the heliograph but it was not <**seen**>.

Why was no distress message <**sent**>?

Perhaps the aerial was <**brought**> down by the explosion.

Why was a radio not <**taken**> to the life-raft?

Where were the two survivors <**picked up**>?

Could an explanation to the disaster ever be <**found**>?

When was the search and rescue <**started**>?

When was it <**suspended**>?

Many lives have been <**lost**> at sea?

Exercise 6

The orders **<have been given>**.

All the lashings must **<be checked>**.

The search **<was continued>** for three hour but SAR found no survivors.

The EPIRB **<was switched on>** automatically when it fell into the water.

Usually the liferafts **<are launched>** on the starboard side.

An emergency message **<has been received>**.

No land could **<be sighted>**.

How has your position **<been obtained>**?

Sometimes the position must **<be calculated>** by dead reckoning.

Conditional Clauses

Exercise 1

If it **<rains>**, I won't go out.

You would learn much more if you **<studied>** sometimes.

If he had asked me, I **<would have told>** him the answer.

You would have done well if you **<had taken>** Peter's advice.

If you need help, my father **<will help|can help|may help>** you.

If we left at once, we **<would catch|could catch|might catch|'d catch>** the early train.

If you wait for a moment, the waiter **<will bring|may bring>** you your coffee.

If he **<wrote>** to her, she would answer at once.

She would never have known Peter if Mary **<had not introduced|hadn't introduced>** him.

If you **<smoked>** less, you would feel much better.

Unless you apologise, I **<will never speak>** to you again.

If I knew, I **<would tell|'d tell>** you.

I would understand Mr Brown if he **<spoke>** more slowly.

If I **<had>** enough money, I would buy a new house.

It would not have seemed such a long walk if she **<had walked>** fast.

Exercise 2

1. If the engines stop working, the vessel **will drift**.
2. If the ship had reduced speed, the waves **wouldn't have hit** the hull so violently.
3. If the people on board the yacht had used lifejackets, they **would have survived** the accident.
4. Television is a good instructor: if you watch it regularly you **will certainly improve** your English.
5. This radio is no good! Nonsense! If you tuned in to the stations correctly, you **would hear** much better.
6. If your radio isn't working, you **can borrow** mine.
7. If the sea is rough, the rescue operations **may sometimes become** very difficult.
8. If there had been no fog, the two ships **would not have collided**.
9. If you had listened to the radio last night, you **would have heard** some very interesting news.
10. If the Captain **had been** more careful, no accident would have happened.
11. If the Captain and a few men had not remained on board, some people **would have laid** their hands on the wreck.
12. If you **buy** an old boat, you must inspect it very carefully.
13. If you watch TV tonight, you **will see** an interesting film.
14. If you **meet** him, give him my address.
15. If you **watch** TV too much, it can be bad for your eyes.
16. If I had not listened to the news last night, I **wouldn't have known** that a railway accident had taken place.

Articles

Exercise 1

1. We require <a> helicopter to rescue <an> injured deckhand.
2. Mr Brown is <an> engineer.
3. Do you like <-> tea or <-> coffee?
4. The Marina is carrying <a> cargo of <-> grain.
5. It is so hot. Can I have <a> glass of <-> cold water?
6. This vessel is made of <-> steel.
7. Peter is studying to be <an> architect.
8. They say that <-> time is <-> money and <-> health is <-> wealth.

9. Is there <a> funnel on this ship?
10. Mr Brown works as <an> able seaman on <a> container vessel.
11. His brother is <a> musician in <an> orchestra.
12. There is <an> electronic chart on the navigating bridge.
13. This table is made of <-> wood.
14. <A> crane operator is <a> man who operates <a> crane.
15. <A> soldier salutes <an> officer.
16. Are you interested in <-> literature?

Exercise 2

1. <-> merchant ships sometimes take <-> passengers.
2. Write your name at <the> top of <the> paper.
3. You can ask for <-> information at <the> information desk.
4. <-> First Aid was given at <the> scene of the accident.
5. <The> second letter of the alphabet is B.
6. <-> dredgers are used to clear <-> channels and <-> fairways.
7. I remember <the> day we went to <the> seaside.
8. <The> Captain was standing on <the> navigating bridge.
9. <The> forecastle deck is at <the> bow.
10. The passengers eat in <the> dining-saloon. It is on <the> port side.
11. Where is <the> windlass?
12. Yesterday was fine. <The> sun was in <the> sky nearly all <the> time.
13. Tell <the> truth.
14. After <the> war he took up his old job.
15. The whole body of a ship is called <the> hull.
16. <The> largest type of cargo ship is <the> tanker.
17. <-> tankers are designed to carry <-> liquid cargo such as <-> oil.
18. On cargo ships <the> bridge superstructure and <the> engine room are situated aft to give more room for <the> cargo.
19. <-> hunger is the best sauce.
20. <-> food and <-> drink are necessary to <-> life.

Exercise 3

LUNCH AT AN OLD INN

On <-> Easter Day Peter and I decided to have <-> lunch at <an> old inn not far from our place. We went there by <-> bus. It took us <an> hour to get there. On <the> bus we met Peter's cousin, who gave us <-> interesting information about <the> inn. He is <a> student of <-> history so he knows all about these old places.

<The> history of <the> inn is really interesting. It is said that in <the> year 1532 the Swedish King spent <a> night at <the> inn. They still show <the> broken chair on which <the> King had sat. They say that when he was eating <-> dinner with some noblemen <the> chair broke into pieces. He must have been <a> heavy man. Upstairs there was <a> picture of <the> Swedish king himself. He looks as true to <-> life as if he had stepped from his frame.

<The> inn is on <a> small river and <the> place is beautiful. Some people came there by <-> boat. On <the> walls of <the> dining-room there are pictures of <-> life on <the> river. Peter's cousin likes <-> good food. He advised us to order <-> roast beef and <-> fresh vegetables. We enjoyed <the> roast beef very much. There was such a lot of it that we didn't have <-> cheese or <-> fruit but went straight on to <-> coffee. It was <a> very nice lunch.

Exercise 4

1. We all know that Christopher Columbus was the first to sail <the> Atlantic Ocean.
2. Magellan made the first sea voyage round <the> world; he rounded <-> South America, crossed <the> Pacific Ocean, and was finally killed in <the> Philippines.
3. Captain Hornblower sailed to <the> West Indies.
4. He also crossed <the> Equator.
5. Who was the first man to round <the> Cape of Good Hope?
6. David Livingston explored <the> whole interior of <-> Africa.
7. He went up <the> Zambesi River and reached <-> Lake Tanganyika, where he thought that he had found <the> source of <the> Nile.
8. He crossed <the> African continent from <the> Atlantic to <the> Indian Ocean.
9. He discovered <the> famous Victoria Falls.

10. Today most of <the> continents have been explored, <the> North Pole and <the> South Pole by many different expeditions.
11. Many years ago there was a film called "The Snows of <-> Kilimanjaro".
12. Have you ever seen <the> Alps?
13. Who was the first man to climb to the top of <-> Mount Everest?
14. Which countries in <-> Europe have you visited?
15. I have been to <-> Sweden, <-> France and <-> Germany.
16. <The> Arctic Ocean is north of Europe and Russia.
17. Have you ever crossed <the> English Channel?
18. Last year I went to <the> Netherlands and saw <the> Hague, where the queen lives.
19. Would you like to visit <the> Canary Islands?
20. When I went to <-> California I saw <the> Sierra Nevada.
21. In what part of <-> Britain is <-> Snowdon, and where are <the> Cheviot Hills?
22. <-> Ben Nevis is a mountain in Scotland.
23. <The> Andes are a mountain range in <-> South America.

Prepositions

Exercise 1

1. Do you often listen **to** the radio?
2. I heard a lovely concert **on** the radio last night.
3. I like to watch American serials **on** TV.
4. My favourite series is on Channel 6 **on** Wednesday evening.
5. They say that it is bad **for** the eyes to watch TV too much.
6. The radio has greatly contributed to safety **at** sea and **in** the air.
7. Ships and aeroplanes are equipped **with** radio so that if they are **in** danger they shall be able to call **for** help.
8. If they send a distress signal, another ship may immediately come **to** the rescue.
9. **By** means **of** radio and TV we are able to know what is going **on in** the world.
10. Seafarers are well-known **for** being superstitious.
11. The ship disappeared **without** a trace.
12. The vessel had a crew **of** 27.
13. The seas were white **with** spray.
14. He was shaking **with** cold, and trembling **with** fear.

15. There was extensive damage **to** the ship.
16. The ship arrived **in** its port of destination.

Exercise 2

This is what a friend of mine, who works in an office in London, told me the other day:

Yesterday I got **on** the train **at** the wrong Underground station. That is why I was a few minutes late **in** getting **to** my office. I knew that I had a long day's work **ahead of** me. I first skimmed **through** the letters that had arrived. I had to work hard **until** half past one. Then I went out and had a late lunch **at** a small restaurant not far **from** my office. **After** lunch I had to go back **to** work **for** a few hours. I didn't get my work finished **until** half past five. It was twenty minutes past six when I arrived **at** the nearest Tube Station, just **in** time to catch the five forty-four. I had dinner **at** seven because I was going **to** the theatre **at** eight-fifteen. I went there **with** some friends **of** mine who take a great interest **in** the theatre. They are very fond **of** music, too, and last week I went **to** a concert **in** their company. **In** three or four weeks' time I am going **to** the country **for** a fortnight, and then I am going to spend a week or two **at** the seaside **with** some friends **of** mine. I am not going to be back **in** London **until** the end **of** August.

Exercise 3

This belongs <**to**> me.

He looked <**at**> them and listened to them.

He looked at them and listened <**to**> them.

I want to thank you <**for**> your help.

She is waiting <**for**> her husband.

The Captain's quarters consist <**of**> two rooms.

She complained <**about**> a headache.

It depends <**on**> many things.

How much did you pay <**for**> the transportation?

The Coast Guard succeeded <**in**> finding the missing boat.

What are you laughing <**at**>?

The idea appealed <**to**> him.

The police would not cope <**with**> the crowd.

What did the bill amount <**to**>?

You must stick <to> your promise.
He paid no attention <to> the weather warning.
You must attend <to> this matter at once.
The Engine cannot do <without> fuel.
He insisted <on> overhauling the equipment.
The Captain had to deal <with> many problems during the voyage.
He is interested <in> many things.
The crew were used <to> hard work.
Are you fond <of> dogs?
No, I'm afraid <of> them.
I am very pleased <with> your work.
Are you sure <of> that?
What is your country famous <for>?
What is the matter <with> you?

Exercise 4

SIR FRANCIS DRAKE

Francis Drake grew up <in> Plymouth, a town <on> the south coast of England. As a boy he liked to watch the ships <in> Plymouth Harbour. He spoke <to> old sailors and listened <to> his cousin Captain Hawkins, who told him stories <of> his adventures <at> sea. Hawkins was fond <of> his young cousin Francis and took him <into> his service. <For> several years Drake was a sailor <on> Captain Hawkins' ship. <At> the age <of> twenty-five Drake was made a mate. <In> 1577 Drake set out <on> his famous voyage <around> the world. His first goal was to cross the Atlantic and pass <-> the Straits of Magellan. His little fleet <of> five vessels set sail <from> Plymouth <in> November.

<After> a long and difficult voyage he reached South America <in> April. The Magellan Strait was narrow with rocks <on> both sides. Because <of> its dangers many sailors had given <up> sailing their ships <through> the strait. The passage seemed too narrow <for> Drake's ships and the men were afraid the ships would be crushed <against> the rocks <in> the violent gales. But <afterlin> less than a fortnight he passed <from> the Atlantic <to> the Pacific Ocean.

He sailed northward searching <for> a harbour and finally found a safe place to lie <at> anchor. He determined to cross the Pacific and called <at> the island <of> Java. He then headed straight <across> the Indian Ocean <for> the Cape of Good Hope. Sailing <to> the north he did not make a stop <on> the African coast.

He made his way <to> the Bay of Biscay and <after> a short time the rocky cliffs <of> England appeared <in> sight. It was <on> a September day <in> 1580 that Drake's ship <after> a voyage <of> nearly three years sailed <into> Plymouth Harbour. Today his statue stands <on> Plymouth Hoe high <above> the harbour looking out <-> the sea.